# Introduction to Machine Learning

## Information Theory

## Joint Entropy and Mutual Information I

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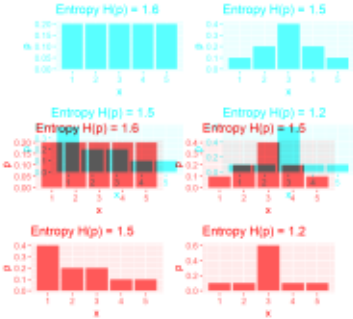


### Learning goals

- Know the joint entropy
- Know conditional entropy as remaining uncertainty
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# JOINT ENTROPY

- Recap: The **joint entropy** of two discrete RVs $X$ and $Y$ with joint pmf $p(x, y)$ is:

$$H(X, Y) = -\sum_{x \in \mathcal{X}} \sum_{y \in \mathcal{Y}} p(x, y) \log(p(x, y)),$$

which can also be expressed as

$$H(X, Y) = -\mathbb{E}\left[\log(p(X, Y))\right].$$

- For continuous RVs $X$ and $Y$ with joint density $p(x, y)$, the differential joint entropy is:

$$h(X, Y) = -\int_{\mathcal{X} \times \mathcal{Y}} p(x, y) \log p(x, y) dxdy$$

For the rest of the section we will stick to the discrete case. Pretty much everything we show and discuss works in a completely analogous manner for the continuous case - if you change sums to integrals.

# CONDITIONAL ENTROPY

- The **conditional entropy** $H(Y|X)$ quantifies the uncertainty of $Y$ that remains if the outcome of $X$ is given.
- $H(Y|X)$ is defined as the expected value of the entropies of the conditional distributions, averaged over the conditioning RV.
- If $(X, Y) \sim p(x, y)$, the conditional entropy $H(Y|X)$ is defined as

$$\begin{aligned} H(Y|X) &= \mathbb{E}_X[H(Y|X=x)] = \sum_{x \in \mathcal{X}} p(x) H(Y|X=x) \\ &= -\sum_{x \in \mathcal{X}} p(x) \sum_{y \in \mathcal{Y}} p(y|x) \log p(y|x) \\ &= -\sum_{x \in \mathcal{X}} \sum_{y \in \mathcal{Y}} p(x, y) \log p(y|x) \\ &= -\mathbb{E}\left[\log p(Y|X)\right]. \end{aligned}$$

- For the continuous case with density $f$ we have

$$h(Y|X) = -\int f(x, y) \log f(x|y) dx dy.$$

# CHAIN RULE FOR ENTROPY

The **chain rule for entropy** is analogous to the chain rule for probability and derives directly from it.

$$H(X, Y) = H(X) + H(Y|X)$$

**Proof:**

$$\begin{aligned} H(X, Y) &= -\sum_{x \in \mathcal{X}} \sum_{y \in \mathcal{Y}} p(x, y) \log p(x, y) \\ &= -\sum_{x \in \mathcal{X}} \sum_{y \in \mathcal{Y}} p(x, y) \log p(x) p(y|x) \\ &= -\sum_{x \in \mathcal{X}} \sum_{y \in \mathcal{Y}} p(x, y) \log p(x) - \sum_{x \in \mathcal{X}} \sum_{y \in \mathcal{Y}} p(x, y) \log p(y|x) \\ &= -\sum_{x \in \mathcal{X}} p(x) \log p(x) - \sum_{x \in \mathcal{X}} \sum_{y \in \mathcal{Y}} p(x, y) \log p(y|x) \\ &= H(X) + H(Y|X) \end{aligned}$$

n-variable version:

$$H(X_1, X_2, \ldots, X_n) = \sum_{i=1}^{n} H(X_i | X_{i-1}, \ldots, X_1).$$

# JOINT AND CONDITIONAL ENTROPY

The following relations hold:

$$H(X, X) = H(X)$$
$$H(X|X) = 0$$
$$H((X, Y)|Z) = H(X|Z) + H(Y|(X, Z))$$

Which can all be trivially derived from the previous considerations.

Furthermore, if $H(X|Y) = 0$ and $X, Y$ are discrete RV, then $X$ is a function of $Y$, so for all $y$ with $p(y) > 0$, there is only one $x$ with $p(x, y) > 0$. Proof is not hard, but also not completely trivial.

# MUTUAL INFORMATION

- The MI describes the amount of info about one RV obtained through another RV or how different their joint distribution is from pure independence.
- Consider two RVs $X$ and $Y$ with a joint pmf $p(x, y)$ and marginal pmfs $p(x)$ and $p(y)$. The MI $I(X; Y)$ is the Kullback-Leibler Divergence between the joint distribution and the product distribution $p(x)p(y)$:

$$
\begin{aligned}
I(X; Y) &= \sum_{x \in \mathcal{X}} \sum_{y \in \mathcal{Y}} p(x, y) \log \frac{p(x, y)}{p(x)p(y)} \\
&= D_{KL}(p(x, y) \| p(x)p(y)) \\
&= \mathbb{E}_{p(x,y)} \left[ \log \frac{p(X, Y)}{p(X)p(Y)} \right].
\end{aligned}
$$

- For two continuous random variables with joint density $f(x, y)$:

$$
I(X; Y) = \int f(x, y) \log \frac{f(x, y)}{f(x)f(y)} dxdy.
$$

# MUTUAL INFORMATION

We can rewrite the definition of mutual information $I(X;Y)$ as

$$
\begin{aligned}
I(X;Y) &= \sum_{x,y} p(x,y) \log \frac{p(x,y)}{p(x)p(y)} \\
&= \sum_{x,y} p(x,y) \log \frac{p(x|y)}{p(x)} \\
&= -\sum_{x,y} p(x,y) \log p(x) + \sum_{x,y} p(x,y) \log p(x|y) \\
&= -\sum_{x} p(x) \log p(x) - \left( -\sum_{x,y} p(x,y) \log p(x|y) \right) \\
&= H(X) - H(X|Y).
\end{aligned}
$$

So, $I(X;Y)$ is reduction in uncertainty of $X$ due to knowledge of $Y$.

# MUTUAL INFORMATION

The following relations hold:

$$I(X;Y) = H(X) - H(X|Y)$$
$$I(X;Y) = H(Y) - H(Y|X)$$
$$I(X;Y) \leq \min\{H(X), H(Y)\} \text{ if } X, Y \text{ are discrete RVs}$$
$$I(X;Y) = H(X) + H(Y) - H(X,Y)$$
$$I(X;Y) = I(Y;X)$$
$$I(X;X) = H(X)$$

All of the above are trivial to prove.

# MUTUAL INFORMATION - EXAMPLE

Let $X$, $Y$ have the following joint distribution:

| | $X_1$ | $X_2$ | $X_3$ | $X_4$ |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| $Y_1$ | $\frac{1}{8}$ | $\frac{1}{16}$ | $\frac{1}{32}$ | $\frac{1}{32}$ |
| $Y_2$ | $\frac{1}{16}$ | $\frac{1}{8}$ | $\frac{1}{32}$ | $\frac{1}{32}$ |
| $Y_3$ | $\frac{1}{16}$ | $\frac{1}{16}$ | $\frac{1}{16}$ | $\frac{1}{16}$ |
| $Y_4$ | $\frac{1}{4}$ | 0 | 0 | 0 |

Marginal distribution of $X$ is $(\frac{1}{2}, \frac{1}{4}, \frac{1}{8}, \frac{1}{8})$ and marginal distribution of $Y$ is $(\frac{1}{4}, \frac{1}{4}, \frac{1}{4}, \frac{1}{4})$, and hence $H(X) = \frac{7}{4}$ bits and $H(Y) = 2$ bits.

# MUTUAL INFORMATION - EXAMPLE / 2

The conditional entropy $H(X|Y)$ is given by:

$$
\begin{aligned}
H(X|Y) &= \sum_{i=1}^{4} p(Y=i)H(X|Y=i) \\
&= \frac{1}{4}H\left(\frac{1}{2},\frac{1}{4},\frac{1}{8},\frac{1}{8}\right) + \frac{1}{4}H\left(\frac{1}{4},\frac{1}{2},\frac{1}{8},\frac{1}{8}\right) \\
&+ \frac{1}{4}H\left(\frac{1}{4},\frac{1}{4},\frac{1}{4},\frac{1}{4}\right) + \frac{1}{4}H(1,0,0,0) \\
&= \frac{1}{4}\cdot\frac{7}{4} + \frac{1}{4}\cdot\frac{7}{4} + \frac{1}{4}\cdot 2 + \frac{1}{4}\cdot 0 \\
&= \frac{11}{8} \text{ bits.}
\end{aligned}
$$

Similarly, $H(Y|X) = \frac{13}{8}$ bits and $H(X,Y) = \frac{27}{8}$ bits.